MAKKAH ZIYARAT: 16

MASJID AL-TANEEM

Location

Approximately 7 to 8 kilometres north of Masjid al-Haram, on the Makkah–Madinah road in the Al-Hil area, Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

Timings

Open 24 hours a day; busiest around the five daily prayers, on Fridays, and during peak Umrah and Ramadan periods.

About This Site

Masjid al-Taneem, commonly known as Masjid Aisha, is one of the most frequented mosques in Makkah after the Grand Mosque. Situated just outside the sacred boundary (Hudud al-Haram), it serves as a key Miqat point where pilgrims enter Ihram for Umrah.

The mosque is named after the area of al-Taneem and is also called Masjid Aisha in honour of Umm al-Mu'mineen Aisha (RA), the wife of our beloved Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. It was from this place that she entered Ihram for Umrah during the Farewell Pilgrimage, following the instruction of the Noble Prophet ﷺ.

For residents of Makkah and pilgrims already within the Haram boundary who wish to perform an additional Umrah, Masjid al-Taneem offers the nearest and most accessible Miqat, making it a central site for Makkah Ziyarat and Umrah preparation.

Historical Significance

The Farewell Pilgrimage and Aisha's (RA) Umrah

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The story of Masjid al-Taneem is closely tied to the Farewell Pilgrimage (Hajjat al-Wada') in 10 AH (632 CE), the only Hajj performed by the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. During this journey, Aisha (RA) began her Hajj in Ihram but could not complete the Umrah portion due to her menstrual period.

Key points from authentic Hadith sources:

- The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ instructed her brother, Abd al-Rahman ibn Abi Bakr (RA), to take her to al-Taneem.
- She entered Ihram for Umrah from there after completing her Hajj rites.
- This established al-Taneem as a recognised place for assuming Ihram, especially for those already in Makkah.

Al-Taneem as a Miqat Point

In Islamic law, a Miqat is a designated boundary where pilgrims must enter Ihram before proceeding to Makkah for Hajj or Umrah. While the five main Miqat points are associated with different directions of travel, al-Taneem serves a special role:

- It is not one of the original five directional Miqats but functions as a secondary Miqat for those already in Makkah.
- Residents of Makkah and pilgrims who wish to perform another Umrah must cross the Haram boundary and enter Ihram from a place like al-Taneem.

This ongoing ritual role ensures that Masjid al-Taneem remains active and meaningful, not merely as a historical landmark but as a living part of the Umrah experience.

Connection with the Wider History of Makkah

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Masjid al-Taneem is part of the network of sites that define the sacred geography of Makkah. It connects with:

- The routes used by the Prophet ﷺ and his companions (RA) for journeys in and around the holy city.
- Other Miqat points that structure the ritual journey of Hajj and Umrah.
- The broader narrative of how Makkah evolved into the centre of Islamic worship and pilgrimage.

While it does not carry the same level of fame as Masjid al-Haram or Jabal al-Nour, al-Taneem occupies an important place in the story of how the early Muslims lived, travelled, and worshipped in and around the holy city.

The Name and Geography of al-Taneem

The name "al-Taneem" is derived from the Arabic root related to "Na'im", referring to the valley and hills in this area. Classical sources describe it as lying between two elevated points, forming a natural gateway on the northern approach to Makkah.

Historical notes:

- Early measurements placed the distance from the Haram boundary marker at al-Taneem to Masjid al-Haram at just over six kilometres; modern roads make the journey approximately 7 to 8 kilometres.
- The area has long been recognised as part of the Hudud al-Haram, the sacred boundary within which certain restrictions apply for pilgrims in Ihram.
- Its location on the Makkah–Madinah road made it a practical point for travellers and pilgrims moving between the two holy cities.

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Scholarly Recognition and Classical Accounts

Recognised Islamic scholars and classical historians have documented the status of al-Taneem as a Miqat and its connection with Aisha's (RA) Umrah. Works such as Mir'at al-Haramayn and local Makkah histories refer to:

- The boundary markers (hudud) at al-Taneem.
- The practice of Makkah residents assuming Ihram from this point.
- The naming of the mosque as Masjid Aisha in later periods, reflecting its association with Umm al-Mu'mineen (RA).

A Miqat of Mercy and Second Chances

Masjid al-Taneem is sometimes described in contemporary guides as a "Miqat of Mercy", reflecting its role in enabling pilgrims to perform additional Umrahs and to renew their intention and devotion. For those who stand here in Ihram, the site becomes a threshold between ordinary life and the intensified worship of Umrah.

Visitors often reflect on:

- The humility required to enter Ihram, leaving behind markers of status and comfort.
- The example of Aisha (RA), whose longing for worship was met with Prophetic compassion.
- The continuity of practice from the time of the Companions (RA) to today's global Muslim community.

The Site Today

Today, Masjid al-Taneem is a large, modern mosque complex designed to accommodate thousands of pilgrims, especially during peak Umrah seasons and Ramadan. The current

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structure is a recent development, built to serve contemporary needs while standing on the traditionally identified site of al-Taneem.

Key points for visitors:

- **What remains**: The mosque stands on the historically recognised location of al-Taneem, where Aisha (RA) entered Ihram for Umrah under the guidance of the Prophet ﷺ.
- **What has changed**: Any early or simple structures have been replaced by a spacious, well-equipped mosque with multiple prayer halls, courtyards, and facilities.
- **What can be seen**: Visitors can pray in the mosque, make the intention for Ihram, and access restrooms, changing areas, and spaces for preparing Ihram garments.
- **Capacity**: The mosque can accommodate around 15,000 worshippers, with additional space in courtyards during busy periods.
- **Access**: It is easily reachable by car, taxi, or public bus from central Makkah, typically within 15 to 25 minutes depending on traffic.

Why Pilgrims Still Visit

Masjid al-Taneem remains meaningful because it links pilgrims directly with a moment in the life of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and with the ongoing ritual framework of Umrah. For those performing Makkah Ziyarat, it offers:

- A chance to follow the Prophetic example in assuming Ihram at a recognised Miqat.
- An opportunity for spiritual reflection on themes of devotion, patience, and renewal.
- A practical solution for residents of Makkah and pilgrims wishing to perform additional Umrahs.

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Frequently Asked Questions

What is the significance of Masjid al-Taneem in Islamic history?

Masjid al-Taneem marks the place where Aisha (RA) entered Ihram for Umrah during the Farewell Pilgrimage under the instruction of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, establishing it as a recognised Miqat for those in Makkah.

Can pilgrims perform Umrah starting from Masjid al-Taneem?

Yes, Masjid al-Taneem is a recognised Miqat point, and pilgrims residing within the Haram boundary or already in Makkah can assume Ihram here for additional Umrahs.

How far is Masjid al-Taneem from Masjid al-Haram and how can I reach it?

It is approximately 7 to 8 kilometres north of Masjid al-Haram on the Makkah–Madinah road, reachable by car, taxi, or public bus, typically in 15 to 25 minutes depending on traffic.

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